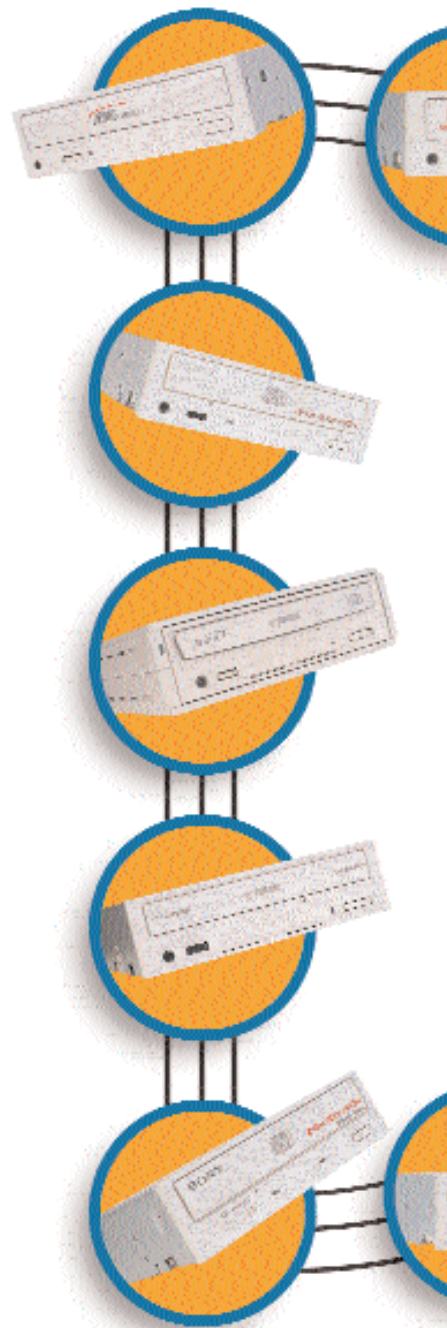
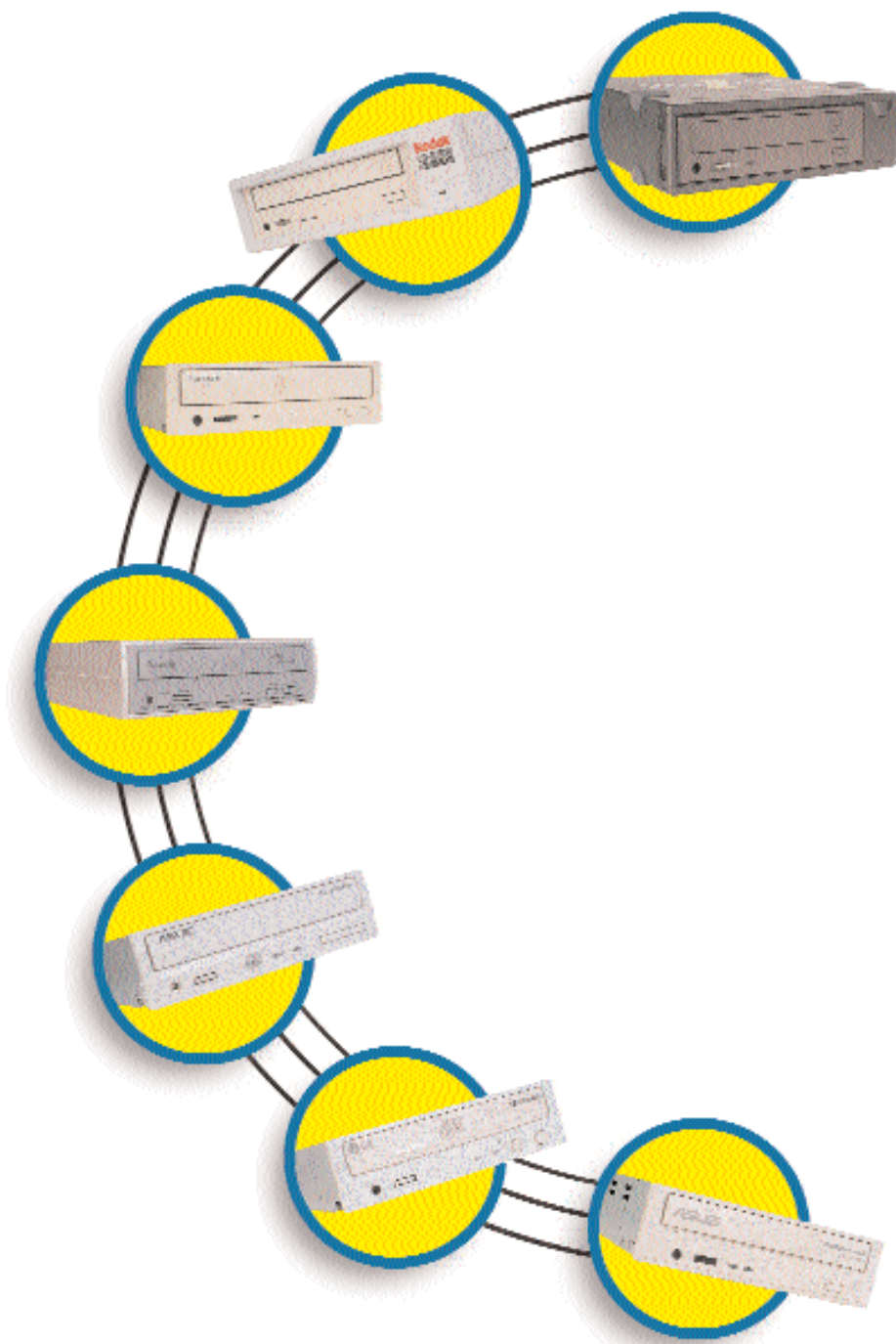




The amount of data that we're subjected to nowadays is truly enormous. Over the past couple of years, we've seen the size of applications and especially that of operating systems grow by orders of magnitude. The latest iteration of Windows, Windows XP, has an install size close to 1 GB! Even the type of files we use on a day-to-day basis have changed. Data types such as MP3 and DivX movies have become common, and most people

wouldn't even bat an eyelid if you were to say to them that you have over 3 GB of songs and movies on your hard disks.

Given all that, most users face a very real paucity of storage space and for most people, buying a new hard disk drive is not a very economical alternative. One of the best solutions to this situation was writeable CDs—an inexpensive backup solution with decent reliability. You could burn your important data on it and simply forget about it. Then came the CD-RW, which gave users the added func-

tionality of rewriting the same disc over and over again. The reliability of the media is more than proven. Unless you manhandle it, your data will remain safe for years to come. Furthermore, the CD-RW media is becoming cheaper and now comes with increased capacity and variations in media quality.

Sadly, the CD-Writer has been out of reach for most users and even the technology was pretty intimidating. But in the past couple of years several inexpensive internal IDE writers have made their